NYC FOOTY
REFEREES

NYC FOOTY REFEREE HANDBOOK

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NYC FOOTY RULES

PARTICIPANTS

*Note, any league-partnerships or COVID-informed changes supersede the default league rules below and will be emailed to teams in advance of the season starting.

NYC Footy leagues are open to any player over the age of 18 at the time of the season's first game.
All players must be listed on the team roster to be eligible to take the field.
All players must sign a liability release waiver online prior to any form of participation in any NYC Footy program or event.
Individual players may only play on one team in each division.
During the regular season, if (and only if) a team shows up with less than the default player format (e.g. seven (7) players in our 7v7 leagues) but more than the number required to avoid forfeit (e.g. five (5) players in our 7v7 leagues), the team may pick up non-roster substitutes that provide up to one sub (e.g. up to three (3) players for a max of 8 players in our 7v7 leagues), if and only if the non-roster substitutes are registered players in the NYC Footy league and has signed a waiver.
In addition, non-roster substitutes cannot be recruited from higher divisions into lower divisions if they break our skill-restrictions. For instance, in a P5 division, no player above a P4 skill-level may be used as a sub. In a P4 division, no player above a P3 skill level may be used as a sub, etc.
NYC Footy operates on an honor system. If a team uses non-roster players to field a team, they notify the referee in advance. The opposing team may also appeal to the referee to confirm non-roster players are being used by their opponent. If the offending team uses non-roster players in a manner that does not abide by the above rules, the offending team must play without those players or lose by forfeit.
Non-Roster substitutes are prohibited from playoff and championship games. No exceptions.
During playoff games, captains may request a roster check, but at the beginning of a playoff game only.

RULES OF THE GAME

All games will be played in accordance with the Laws of the Game issued by FIFA through USSF and are available for viewing at https://www.theifab.com/laws-of-the-game-documents/.

Modifications made in these by-laws supersede and/or supplement the Laws of the Game.

INDOOR RULES (NEW)

All players must wear shin guards.
On hard surfaces court (e.g. hardwood, gym courts) cleats are not allowed.
For 4v4, 5v5 and 6v6 format, when the ball goes out of bounds, the restart will be a kick-in. During the kick-in the ball must be kicked at "below-the-waist" height. If the ball is kicked above the waist the ball possession will change to the opposing team that will restart with a kick-in from the same location.
For 4v4, 5v5, and 6v6 format, Goalkeepers must ensure the ball touches the ground before the halfway line with throws, kick-ins or punts. If this rule is violated, the opposing team receives possession from the midfield sideline.

CODE OF CONDUCT

Participation in NYC Footy is in accordance with our Ted Lasso Code of Conduct, which can be found here: https://www.nycfooty.com/ted-lasso-code-of-conduct.

COED GAME PLAY

Depending on the league, a full playing team can be five (5) or more players. In a 5v5 league, a minimum of three (3) players is required to start and finish a match. In a 6v6 league, a minimum of four (4) players is required to start and finish a match. In a 7v7 or 8v8 league, a minimum of five (5) players is required to start and finish a match. In our 11v11 league, a minimum of eight (8) players is required to start and finish a match.
Our default* protocol for female minimums is as follows: In our 5v5 leagues there is a minimum of one (1) female; in our 6v6, 7v7 and 8v8 leagues, a minimum of two (2) females; in 9v9 and 11v11 leagues, a minimum of three (3) women is required at all times. Depending on registrations, this can change on a league-by-league or division by

division basis. We also run female-majority leagues. Please refer to the actual league or division detail page when inquiring about coed game play for your league or division. **NYC Footy operates alternative format leagues, like our FLIP leagues, where our gender requirements are different.*
If a team does not have the required amount of female players, it must play down a player. For instance, in a 7v7 league, teams playing with one (1) female will play with six (6) total players and teams playing with no (0) females will play with five (5) total players.
During the regular season only*, in leagues with 2+ minimum female requirements, a team without the required amount of female players *has a choice to give the opponent 3 goals and replace one female spot with a non-female player. If a team is down more than one female player, they will only be able to leverage the 3 goal penalty once (thus, said team will not have an opportunity to play at full strength). If a team takes a 3 goal penalty and a female player arrives late that would meet the league minimum requirements, the team must revert to the official format and honor league minimums (however, the 3 goal penalty still stands).*This option is not available during playoffs.*
If a free agent team assembled by NYC Footy does not have the requisite number of female players on their roster, they will be labeled FAx ("x' signifies exception). In this scenario, the game format featuring an FAx team will reduce the female minimum requirement by one (1) female to protect the free agent experience.
The game format reduction will apply ONLY for the first two (2) weeks of the season, allowing 3 weeks for the team to leverage FootyHQ and other resources to recruit more female players. Starting Week 3, the 'x' is removed and the team is subject to the official format.
FAx Teams with a female minimum reduced to one (1) for their game(s) are not eligible for the exchange of 3-goals for a female replacement.
Under no circumstances, may a team field a full strength team with only male players.
NYC Footy operates alternative format leagues, like our FLIP leagues, where our gender requirements are different.

- *FLIP leagues are formats that require a greater number of female players on the pitch. Our standard 7v7 FLIP leagues require a minimum of 5 female players on the pitch. Our FLIP 50/50 leagues require a minimum of 3 female players on the pitch in our standard 7v7 format.*
- There is not an off-side rule in NYC Footy for the majority of our leagues (excludes 11v11 leagues).
  All free kicks (including kick-offs, goal kicks, and corner kicks) are indirect except for penalty kicks.
  A goal cannot be scored directly from a kickoff, a corner kick, a throw in, a goal kick, or a goalkeeper throw. The ball must make contact with another player first (this includes the goalie).
  A goalkeeper cannot pick up a throw in.
  Penalty kicks are taken at the top of the penalty box. Keepers may move from side-to-side on the goal line, but not forward on a penalty kick. There is no limit to the amount of steps the offensive player takes prior to kicking the ball during a penalty kick.
  Opposing teams must give all free kicks seven (7) yards of space immediately or a yellow card may be issued for delay of game.
  Slide tackling or sliding in a dangerous/reckless manner is prohibited. A goalkeeper may slide to block shots and make saves, but only inside the keeper's own penalty box. Any slide deemed dangerous/reckless by the referee will be penalized.

Substitutions are unlimited, and may be made on the fly (formerly on dead balls only), so long as the player subbing out is completely out of the field of play before the player subbing in enters AND the subbing team does **not** receive an advantage from the substitution.

Exceptions to the "sub on the fly" rule are made for certain facilities, where subbing on the fly is deemed to be dangerous (e.g. Upper 90 Soccer Center, Chelsea Piers Field House, etc.).
Goalkeeper changes can ONLY be made on a dead ball and only after notifying the referee and receiving approval. All keeper changes initiated on the fly may result in a yellow card at the referee's discretion.
All substitutions will be made from the same location for each team throughout the game (sideline or end line) as determined by the referee.
Violation of the sub rule (e.g. if a player subbing in enters the field of play before the player subbing out leaves), will result in an indirect free kick to the opposing team, unless an advantage is played (to the opposing team).

CAUTIONS AND DISCIPLINE

Yellow and red cards are issued under the same cardable offenses outlined by the USSF:
Yellow Card Offenses: Players receiving a yellow card are required to sub off for a minimum of 2 minutes. The offending player's team can substitute for the offending player. If the offense is deemed particularly egregious, though remaining short of a red card offense, the referee can have a player sit for 5 minutes.

Second Yellow Card Offenses: A second yellow card offense requires the player to sit out for the remainder of the match, but may return during their next match. The team can substitute for the offending player and not not need to play down a player (new rule as of fall 2022).
Red Card Offenses: Players allotted a red card shall be immediately ejected from the game and must leave the field of play immediately for the remainder of the game.

If the ejected player was actively on the field of play at the time of the red card, the ejected player's team must play the remainder of the game down a player.
First Red Card Offense: Player suspension of a minimum of one full game (extended suspensions may result depending on the severity of the offense).
Second Red Card Offense: Player is suspended for the remainder of the season and/or beyond (depending on the nature of the red card offenses).
Third Red Card Offense (in aggregate): Three red card offenses in aggregate (no matter the number of seasons it took to accumulate 3 red cards) results in permanent suspension from all NYC Footy related programs and activities (after one-full year, expelled players may submit a request to be considered for re-introduction).

Any player shown a red card by a referee is required to provide their name to the referee when requested. If they refuse, the team captain is responsible for providing the name of the player receiving the red.

In the event the player and/or captain do not honor the referee's request, the captain will be cautioned, the game ended, and the team will register a forfeit with a -1 point deduction in the standings.

If the player receiving a red card provides anything other than their real name, and/or that player is discovered to be unregistered, then the team will face additional sanctions determined by the league.

Upon request by the referee or supervisor, ejected players may be called for a review by the NYC Footy board.

Any player who is involved in a fight is subject to suspension for the remainder of the season or expulsion from the league, entirely (depending on the severity of the incident).

Any player who initiates intentional physical contact upon a referee or a NYC Footy representative shall be given a red-card and suspended from all NYC Footy programs indefinitely.

REPORTING AN INCIDENT

Whenever a red card offense or serious incident occurs during a game, we ask you to fill out this form for an incident to be formally processed by NYC Footy.
To learn more about our incident reporting process, please visit here.

REPORTING A DISRUPTION

Whenever a game is disrupted as a result of facility or equipment malfunction, facility closure, referee delay, referee absence, etc., we ask you to fill out this form for a disruption to be formally processed by NYC Footy.
To learn more about our incident reporting process, please visit here.

UNIFORMS AND EQUIPMENT

All teams must wear their assigned NYC Footy jersey (goalkeepers are excluded as of now).
If a team wishes to wear custom jerseys, they must do so through NYC Footy's customization process. Email info@nycfooty.com for more information.
If a field player does not have the official NYC Footy jersey assigned to them and they decide to take the field, the referee will announce that the opponent will receive one (1) goal for every player that takes the field without their official NYC Footy jersey (no cap on the amount of goals gifted. Goalkeepers are exempt from the jersey rule).
Goalkeepers must wear a different color jersey easily identifiable by the referee. Keeper Jerseys may be provided by the NYC Footy.
All players must wear real shin guards (cardboard or balled socks, for example, doesn't count) and high-socks in order to take the field.
All players must wear soccer appropriate footwear to play. No metal or steel cleats or spikes are allowed.
A #5 game ball will be provided for game play. Teams should bring their own balls for warm up.

GAME DURATION

Depending on the league and league format, all divisions will have anywhere from 18-28 minute halves with up to a five (5) minute break at half time.
The game clock will start at the scheduled game start time. Thus, it is critical that you take the field in a timely manner to maximize game time.
Clock will run continuously and the half and game shall end at the expiration of time.
If a game is called due to injury, weather or unexpected circumstances, the game will be considered complete if it has reached the halfway mark or later.

FORFEIT RULE

Teams have a five minute grace period from the start of kickoff to field the required minimum number of players or the team will forfeit the game. However, there may be some occasions when games are unable to start at the scheduled kickoff. Forfeit time on these occasions will be when the officials call both teams to start the game.
Forfeits <u>with</u> advanced notice (3+ hours prior to kickoff) will be treated as a 3-0 loss and a -1 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
Forfeits <u>without</u> advanced notice (<3 hours prior to kickoff) will be treated as a 3-0 loss and a -2 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
Forfeits resulting from not enough players arriving on-time will be treated as a 3-0 loss and a -2 point deduction to the forfeiting team.
Two forfeits in a season disqualifies a team from playoff contention.
Multiple forfeits from teams or no-shows from free agent players can result in suspension from future leagues. Those teams or players may not be permitted to register in future seasons.

PLAYOFF RULES

All players must be formally rostered and wear their official NYC Footy jerseys.
Captains may request the referee to do a roster check at the beginning of the game. Roster checks will not be allowed after the game has begun.
Due to limits on field availability and ensuring our schedules remain on time, there is no overtime in NYC Footy leagues. If the score is tied with 2 minutes left in the game the referee will notify both teams that at the end of regulation we will initiate penalty kicks.

PENALTY KICKS

Players will take five penalty kicks, alternating genders (M-F-M-F-M or F-M-F-M-F).
If tied after the first five PKs then it goes one-on-one, alternating genders, until there is a winner.
Players go in order and then repeat in order. For example, if a team has three female players and five male players, the female players will begin repeating before all male players have gone (or vice versa).
The ball is placed on the top of the box and players can take as many steps toward the ball as they want.
The keeper can move from side-to-side on the goal line, but cannot move forward until the ball is kicked.
All other players must be outside the box and behind the kicker and remain still.
Players must be silent while the kick is taking place.

<u>LEAGUE SCHEDULES AND STANDINGS</u>

SCHEDULES & RESCHEDULES

Schedules will be posted prior to the beginning of the season.

Games are played rain or shine.
Games will only be canceled due to hazardous weather conditions (extreme temperatures, lightning, severe thunderstorm warning, tornado warning, hurricanes…) or hazardous or limiting field conditions (e.g. field lights are not functioning).
NYC Footy will communicate via the captain's chat and/or via an email notifying the league of postponement or cancellation.

Note, we do not cancel games based solely on weather forecasts. Unfortunately, weather forecasts (e.g. scattered thunderstorms) do not provide accurate enough data, by location, to inform cancellations. Thus, we instruct our referees to conduct a “delay-and-play’ protocol. This means that if games are on and thunderstorms subsequently enter the area, the game will be paused and players will seek cover. If after 15 minutes, the thunderstorms continue, the game will be called. Otherwise, the players will retake the field.
If a game has completed at least one full half and is subsequently abandoned due to player injury, safety reasons, or otherwise, the game is considered “complete” and the recorded outcome will be the scoreline at the time the game is abandoned. If a game is abandoned in the first half, the league will attempt to schedule a re-match. If the league is unable to reschedule the game, the scoreline will be recorded as a 0-0 tie.
If games are delayed as a result of weather or administrative failures, then the active game affected by the delay will be played in full and subsequent games will have delayed kickoff times (captains will be notified of the delay in the captain’s chat). If there is not enough time to complete all games, then the last scheduled game will be postponed and subsequently rescheduled.
Please note, that due to limits on the number of available weeks on a permit, it can be extremely difficult to make up canceled games. Therefore, we cannot guarantee all canceled games will be rescheduled, but we promise to do our very best to try and reschedule games. Players should be prepared for the possibility of playing rescheduled games at different fields, days or times in order to successfully make up for the canceled games.
If a team must forfeit a game that is rescheduled on a different day of the week and/or at a different field, the forfeit will be confirmed, but no point deduction will take place.
If a reschedule date is not made available to teams, then the game will be canceled from the schedule entirely. Depending on the nature of the disruption (e.g. act of God, administrative failure, etc.) compensation may be provided to teams in the form of credits or discount codes.
Note, similar to all soccer leagues amateur and professional, if a reschedule date is scheduled, even if at a different time and/or location, teams are expected to attend the match.
Teams offered reschedule dates are not eligible for credits or refunds.
For more information about our weather protocol, visit here.

STANDINGS

League points will be appointed as follows:

Win = 3 points
Draw = 1 point
Loss = 0 points
Forfeit = -1 (w 3 hr notice) or -2 points (w less than 3 hour notice).

The majority of NYC Footy leagues will be decided by a playoff. The number of teams that qualify for the playoffs depends on a combination of factors, primarily the number of teams in the division. For instance, divisions of 5-6 teams have a Top 3 default, divisions of 7-10 teams have a Top 4 default. Exceptions are typically made as a result of permit availability.

TIEBREAKERS

In the event of a tie, the following tie breakers will be used:

League goal differential.
League total goals scored
League Points in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Goal differential in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Goals Scored in head to head competition in games between tied teams
Coin flip – in the event that tie breaker reaches a coin flip, contending teams will be notified at least 24 hours in advance of coin flip time and location. Teams can send a representative witness to coin flip.

PRICING & DUES

NYC Footy collects dues on a team (captain) or individual (e.g. free agent) basis.
Captains are responsible for the entire team fee (NYC Footy does not collect full team fees from individual team players).
NYC Footy allows captains to make a $250 deposit to secure a spot. Dues must be paid in full prior to the start of a season. If full payment is not completed one week prior to scheduled kickoff, the team will be removed and the deposit will be forfeited. If leagues continue to accept registration after the season starts, then accepted registrations must complete payment in full at the time of registration. Exceptions may be granted for corporate

leagues that require invoices to submit payment.
If a team captain needs NYC Footy to provide additional players, NYC Footy will help find free agent individual players. If successful, NYC Footy will credit the captain 75% the fee paid by the free agent to NYC Footy or the individual team player fee, whichever is lower.
Leagues are priced into categories or pricing “tiers” based on a range of factors, including:
Demand
Location
Days & Times
Field Conditions

For refunds and credits, please visit our refund and credit policy.

MISCELLANEOUS ITEMS

NYC Footy operates on an honor system, including honoring the skill level of play across NYC Footy leagues, which are governed by our “P” system. This means if advanced players register for a beginner league, this is a breach of our code of conduct. Moreover, if a full team registers for an inappropriate skill division (e.g. A P2 level team registering for a P4 division), as reported to us by league officials, that team will forfeit their playoff spot to another team.
NYC Footy will continue to work hard training referees to enforce all NYC Footy rules. However, in the event a team is playing without the appropriate equipment or gender requirements and the referee has not announced the violation, the opponent should notify the referee within the first 10 minutes of the game. If a game reaches a conclusion without NYC Footy rules having been enforced and teams notified if goal advantages were given (e.g. for not wearing the appropriate NYC Footy jersey), the scoreline will stand. If NYC Footy is notified of the violation after the fact, NYC Footy will use this information to address the referee, but will not retroactively adjust the scoreline.
Alcoholic beverages are not permitted in any field. We will be hosting off-field events with drink specials at neighboring bars. Please reserve your drinking to the bars, not the field.
Illegal drugs are not permitted at all NYC Footy sanctioned events.
Clean up after yourselves! Please help keep our NYC parks clean. Don’t leave empty water bottles, trash, or other items behind. Teams leaving messes will receive a warning on first offense followed by a loss of league points for future offenses.
NYC Footy is a fun adult recreational league for all to enjoy. Please help us keep a fair and positive vibe on and off the field.
Note: Certain league rules may be suspended on an as needed basis (e.g. if a major event may signify team quotas are difficult to fulfill) and will be communicated in advance to any/all leagues impacted.

REFEREE GUIDELINES

NYC FOOTY REFEREE GUIDELINES: WORKING A REFEREE SHIFT - Checklist

1.) ALWAYS bring **2 balls (provided by NYC Footy), cones (provided by NYC Footy), 2 different colored referee uniforms, whistle, red/yellow cards, watch, pen & paper, ball pump**.

2.) **Show up early with your uniform ON, be visible to players. (New NOV 2024) BE PROACTIVE.** If there are any issues in accessing the field or other obstacles to starting your shift, notify the Ref Ops chat *immediately*. Don't wait. DO NOT DM ADMINS - they are in rotation so you might DM someone who is off duty. The Ref Ops chats exist to provide for the most visibility by all admins. (In cold weather, it is required that your uniform is visible as the top layer; you can layer underneath as needed.)

3.) Clock-in on the Homebase app (double-check that it went through, technology can be tricky sometimes). **Do not clock in before you're on the field.**

4.) Start field setup (as needed), Some fields have painted lines, some do not and therefore need cones laid out to mark the goal lines, touch lines, and goal boxes. Goal boxes should be 8 generous steps from each goal post [width] and 10 generous steps up from the goal line (vertical) for 7v7. Adjust accordingly for smaller/bigger fields. Be sure to have the field ready before the scheduled kickoff - shift times are built to accommodate the setup time for each field.

5.) **Start games on time.** Blow your whistle 2 minutes before game time and ask teams to get their starting team on the field. Have the coin toss and let people know you will be starting the game. This is when you should be talking to teams about shin guards, watches, FitBits, hats (see below). If teams are still not ready by game time, announce that the clock has started and **start your watch**.

*Before you blow your whistle to start the game, confirm that everyone on both teams have shin guards on and if they have any watches or FitBits that they are covered by a tennis wristband. [only regulated shin guards count—no paper, cardboard, etc.], Make sure no one is wearing a cap (goalkeepers on a sunny day are an exception). Regarding the jersey rule, our goal is to ensure teams look as professional as possible, when someone does not have the proper NYC FOOTY jersey of the same color, if you haven't started the game yet, ask if they have the proper jersey or if the captain can provide it for them. If they don't have it then, announce to both captains and make it clear that you're going to give a goal to the other team. If someone comes on the pitch not having the proper jersey after you've already started the game, stop the play as soon as you notice and proceed the same way as mentioned above.

6.) Officiate your games and **manage your time.** Our games are based on time. *See the Game Duration Guide below the guidelines

GAME DURATION: 45 Min Slot (2X20min), 48 Min Slot (2x21min), 50 Min Slot (2x22min), 55 Min Slot (2X25), 60 Min Slot (2x27)

A. Get games started on time
B. If games get started late, shorten the half-time
C. If shortening the half-time is not enough, then shave time off of each half equally and keep it to yourself

7.) **Use one ball per game (but bring 2 with you) and make sure that only Footy balls are used in match play**.

If balls go out of bounds make players chase the balls and only use one ball per game. If the ball goes really far then ask a substitute to get the ball or do not start play until the original ball is back on the field.

8.) Display friendly, competent, **professional** conduct during games:

Call the games tight from the very beginning. In the event of an action worthy of a caution, don't be afraid to use your cards early in order to set a high standard of conduct. Loose games lead to the potential escalation of violence and injuries. Start tight because you can always loosen up. If you start loose, it is extremely difficult to tighten your calls later as you have already set the tone.

In the event of a red card, a major injury or something that needs admin attention, you're required to fill out an Incident Report on the Referee App and notify your Head Refs via Homebase/Text/Call. We are a friendly league where people have to go to work in the morning. (You do not need to file an incident report for yellow cards.) (Android users: you can submit your incident reports through our standard report form at this link.)

Blow your whistle firmly. Verbalize and signal your calls clearly. Players will inevitably get excited during the game, and they will be more likely to argue with and get out of hand if the officiating is too quiet or unclear. Referees will make mistakes - stick with your call as you saw it, and be firm with players about dissent: **one** verbal warning **at most** before issuing a yellow card. At the end of the game, players will appreciate your clarity and direction, even if there was a mistake made. Show that you are in control of the match, while being fair, firm, and friendly.

Do not use your phone during games, and *and wearing earphones/airpods during games is strictly prohibited. (If you require hearing assistance please reach out to NYC Footy admins for an accessibility exception.) (***ADDED MAR 2025**) You should keep score using a pen and paper, or on the back of your cards. Only use your phone to clock in, register the FINAL score, and clock out. We don't want our players to think you're browsing online during a match, or checking messages/social media.

9.) Announce your final score to the teams (this prevents disputes after the fact), and record your scores in the Ref HQ app (in the event you are having technical difficulties, report them in the Ref Ops Whatsapp chat for that league.

Always report team names as team colors are not reliably consistent in the app.) Scores not submitted within 12 hours of the end of the match will be logged as missing scores and may make you ineligible for seasonal bonuses or other perks. Please don't make us chase you for scores.

Keep accurate track of your scores—IMPORTANT: You must maintain a copy of all scores for the length of the current season [added May 2024]. If the scores are wrong, teams will write to us and we will follow up with you.

In case there's a forfeit on the last scheduled game of the shift and there's no teams showing up, wait the 5 minutes as per Footy Rules**.** After that your shift is considered over, that means you can start breaking down (if needed), send your scores on the app and clock-out. If one team is present, they can use the field for the scheduled time and scrimmage one of the previous game teams and in that case you'll stay on site until the end of your scheduled shift. If you have any issues with the shift/app please let your Head Refs know after your shift. Communication is Key.

10.) Make use of the Notes section of the Ref HQ App. Any cards, incidents, or game details that may be important for future reference should be included here. In the event of a playoff or championship game, record the penalty shootout outcome here. If it is easier for you to write details in a language other than English, please feel free to do so!

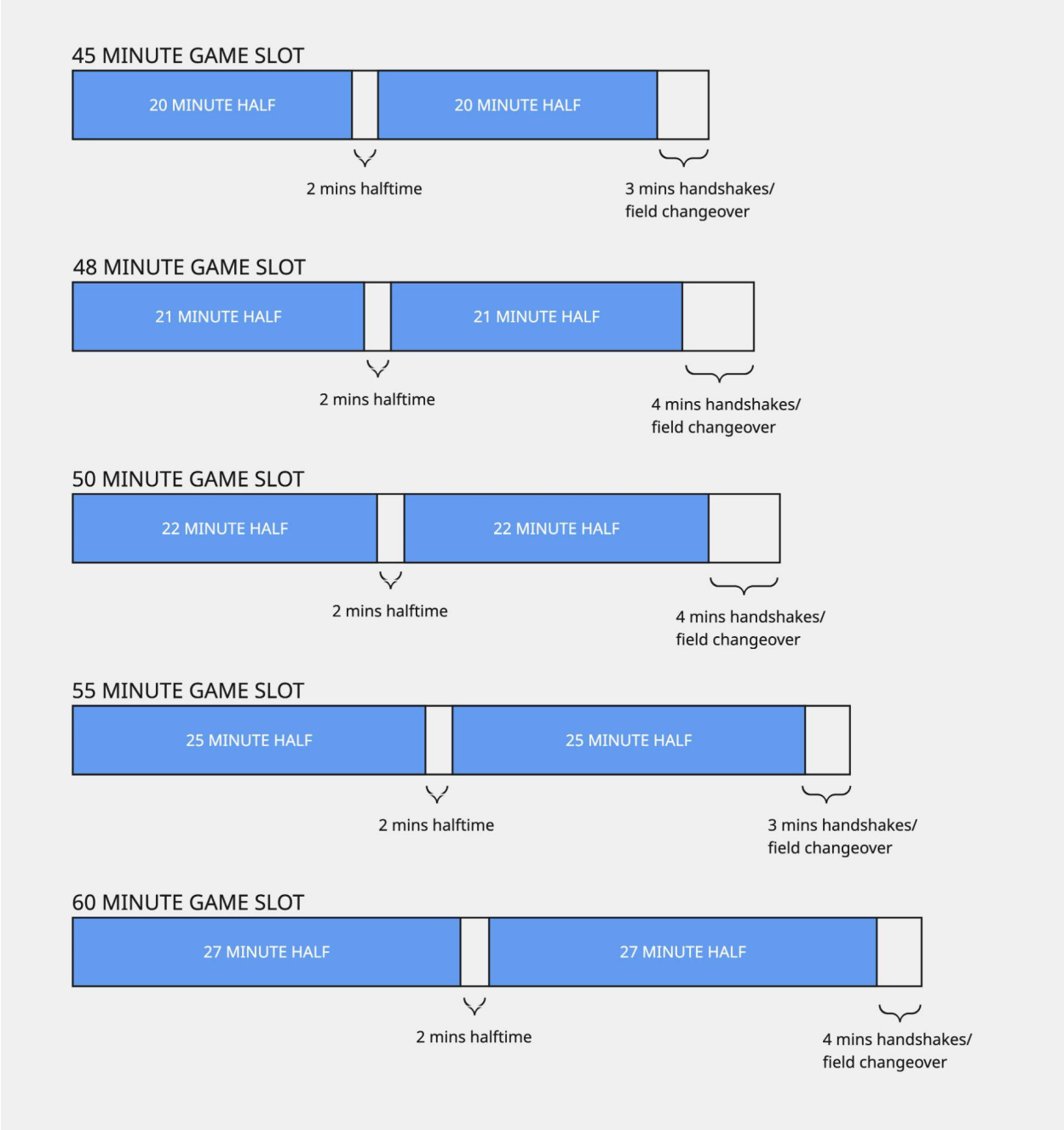
11.) Do a postgame equipment report: balls, cones, goal and field condition**. Submit any equipment needs into the Ref HQ app. (Go to the FLAGS tab, and tap the + sign in the top right corner.) DO NOT WAIT until the next day to make equipment requests, these may not be filled in time if you delay.** (Android users: submit your equipment requests into the Ref Ops chat of the shift you have just worked, as soon as you conclude your equipment check.)

12.) Once the game is concluded, clear your field and collect cones/ break down goals as needed at the site (follow instructions in the Ref Ops chat for correct procedures at each field.) Please leave fields as good as or better than you found them.

IMPORTANT - Post photos of locked up goals/ scrambled lockbox locks per the location instructions.

Clock out on Homebase while still on the field (not off site or after you're in transit. Multiple off-site clock-outs in a season may also make you ineligible for bonuses or perks.

GAME DURATION GUIDE



REFEREE CHECKLIST

REFEREE REQUIREMENTS

Uniforms (2 Different Colors)
Whistle
Cards
Watch
Pen & Paper
Ball Pump
NYC FOOTY Balls (Minimum of 2 PUMPED Balls)
Cones

TEAM REQUIREMENTS

SHIN GUARDS ON
NYC FOOTY JERSEY ON
WATCHES/FITBIT COVERED
FEMALE MINIMUM REQUIREMENTS MET
NO DANGEROUS ITEMS ON
NO METAL/SPIKES CLEATS
NO CAPS ON (EXCLUDING GOALIES - BEANIES ARE ALLOWED)
GOALKEEPER WEARING A DIFFERENT COLOR JERSEY

DRUGS AND ALCOHOL POLICY

The safety and security of NYC Footy employees, contractors, customers, and the public is and needs always be our top priority.

While on an active shift NYC Footy strictly prohibits referees and/or staff from being under the influence of drugs or alcohol. Any referee or staff member who is reasonably suspected by NYC Footy admin (either through direct interaction or through a post-accusation investigation) to be working while under the influence of drugs or alcohol will be promptly suspended, during which time they will be unable to access any of the NYC Footy fields, tools and group communication systems.

If we are able to confirm that the referee or staff member was under the influence, it will be grounds for immediate termination. To help ensure that any violations are identified, any person who reasonably suspects that a referee or staff member is under the influence of drugs or alcohol while working may submit an incident report to NYC Footy. Referees and/or staff members are also expected to let us know if they reasonably suspect another referee or staff member of being under the influence of drugs or alcohol while working.

Referees, staff members, players/members and/or employees should report these concerns using

the online incident report form, which can be found by visiting www.nycfooty.com. In case of emergency and/or if you feel in immediate danger do not hesitate to call **911**.

Regardless of who submits the report, NYC Footy will promptly conduct an investigation and take appropriate action. Once a determination is made regarding a reported incident of drug and/or alcohol use, the individual in question will be notified in writing via email. If the individual is found to have violated our Policy, said individual may be terminated of their official duties to NYC Footy and may be suspended from any or all NYC Footy sanctioned events and programs as well as any NYC Footy operational tools (e.g. Homebase, WhatsApp, Circle, Slack, etc.).

Importance of submitting a report in good faith

We take all reports seriously and will take appropriate action against those who report knowingly false information or report with an intent to injure a referee and/or staff member.

NYC Footy may suspend any referee, staff member, and/or player/member found to be reporting an alleged violation of this policy in bad faith. Suspension includes removal from any or all of NYC Footy sanctioned events and programs as well as any NYC Footy operational tools (e.g. Homebase, WhatsApp, Circle, Slack etc.).

HOMEBASE LOCATION CODES

- **ASG - Asphalt Green**
- **AST – Astoria Park**
- **AUL – Soho Aula Gym**
- **AVE – Avenues of the World School**
- **BANK – Riverbank State Park**
- **BAR – Baruch Playground**
- **BAT – Battery Park Ballfields**
- **BBP – Brooklyn Bridge Park**
- **BIP – Bushwick Inlet Park**
- **BOOK – Booker T Washington Playground**
- **BUSH – Bush Terminal Field**
- **CHE – Chelsea Park**
- **COL – Columbus Park**
- **COM – Commodore Barry Park**
- **COR – Corlears Hook**
- **CPFH – Chelsea Piers Field House Brooklyn**

- **CPNM –** Central Park North Meadow
- **CWP –** Chelsea Waterside Park
- **DEAN –** Dean Playground
- **DEW –** DeWitt Clinton Park
- **DWT –** The Dwight School
- **ELD –** LES Settlement House Indoor
- **ERP –** East River Park
- **FOR –** Force Soccer Studios
- **FRED –** Fred Douglas Playground
- **GAE –** Gaelic Park
- **GAN –** Gansevoort Peninsula
- **GRE –** Greenwich House Indoor
- **GRO –** Grover Cleveland Playground
- **GSB –** The German School
- **HAM –** Hamilton Metz
- **HAR –** Harlem River Park
- **JJC –** John Jay College
- **JJW –** JJ Walker Park
- **LEM –** Leman Preparatory School
- **LIO –** Lionsgate
- **LIU-I –** LIU Brooklyn
- **MAF –** Mafera Park
- **MAJ –** Bedford Armory-Major Owens
- **MCL –** McLaughlin Park
- **MCRN –** McCarren Park
- **MET –** Met Oval
- **MRX –** Marx Bros Playground
- **MUR –** Murray Playground
- **NIK –** Nike Field
- **NORD –** Nord Anglia International School
- **P40-C –** Pier 40 Courtyard

- **P40-R –** Pier 40 Rooftop
- **P42 –** Pier 42
- **PETE –** Peter's Field
- **POST –** The Post Williamsburg
- **POST-B –** The Post Bushwick
- **PROS –** Prospect Park Parade Grounds
- **QWST –** Gantry Plaza State Park LIC
- **RED-1 –** Red Hook Ballfields
- **REI –** Reinaldo Salgado Playground
- **RICH –** Julia Richman School
- **RIV-101 –** Riverside Park 101st
- **RIV-4 –** Riverside Park 71st
- **ROB –** Robert Moses Playground
- **ROO –** Roosevelt Island
- **SGA –** Stephen Gaynor School
- **SJP –** St. John's Park
- **SRF-C –** SoccerRoof Crown Heights
- **SRF-L –** SoccerRoof Long Island City
- **SRF-S –** SoccerRoof Sunset Park
- **SRP –** Sara Roosevelt Park
- **STAR –** Star Spangled Playground
- **STE –** Sternberg Park
- **SUN –** Sunset Park Outdoor
- **TAN –** Tanahey Playground
- **THO –** Thomas Jefferson Park
- **U90 –** U90 Astoria
- **U90-R –** U90 Astoria Rooftop
- **VAR –** St. Vartan Park
- **VCP –** Van Cortlandt Park
- **WAG –** Wagner Playground
- **WAS –** Washington Park

REFEREE HQ APP

SCORES and MATCH LIST

Please read these instructions in **FULL!**

A few quick steps required:
-For Apple Users

1. Download and Install the App GET IT HERE
2. Must sign in with the same email address used for Homebase
3. Once you're signed in, you'll be able to access your games, upcoming shifts and much more
4. To report scores, click on the game, insert the score and click on Submit Score. If you need to change the score of the game, click on Undo and re-submit the score.
5. On each game's page there's also a section to add Incident Reports (Injuries, Red Cards, Forfeits) that Admins can see so use that tool for any incident that needs to be completed.

-For Android Users

1. Add this phone number to your contacts: **6094733733**
2. You will now be able to text the number and start adding scores. Make sure you use the same phone number used for Homebase.
3. To view your schedule for the day just type and send **Schedule.** To view an upcoming or past shift schedule type **Schedule and the date in the MM/DD/YYYY format**. Ex. Schedule 02/05/2023.
4. To report scores, type and send **Report**. You'll receive a text with your games and the scores will be marked as X-X. You'll simply need to copy that text, replace the X-X with the actual scores and send it back. To view/edit an upcoming or past shift report type **Report and the date in the MM/DD/YYYY format**. Ex. Report 02/05/2023.
5. After sending it, you'll be receiving a Games Reported text that will confirm that your scores are being imported on the App.

So far the Referee HQ app is looking great, but as we all know technology can fail sometimes, for both Apple and Android users **you're still required to keep a copy of scores and have them handy in case we need them**. You must maintain a record of scores somewhere (on your phone notes, on a paper, etc.) until the season is done (we may ask you for a January 3rd score confirmation on March 5th, it can happen). If you want you can still send a copy of your scores to the Ref Ops Chat. Don't lose your scores. Submit them on the app and save them somewhere.

COVERAGE REQUESTS

Our expectation is that when you get assigned to a shift for the entire season you're fully committed to it every week. We also know that life happens and there might be some unpredictable events that will have you in need requesting coverage. That's why we've prepared this short document to guide you through the procedure for the coverage request.

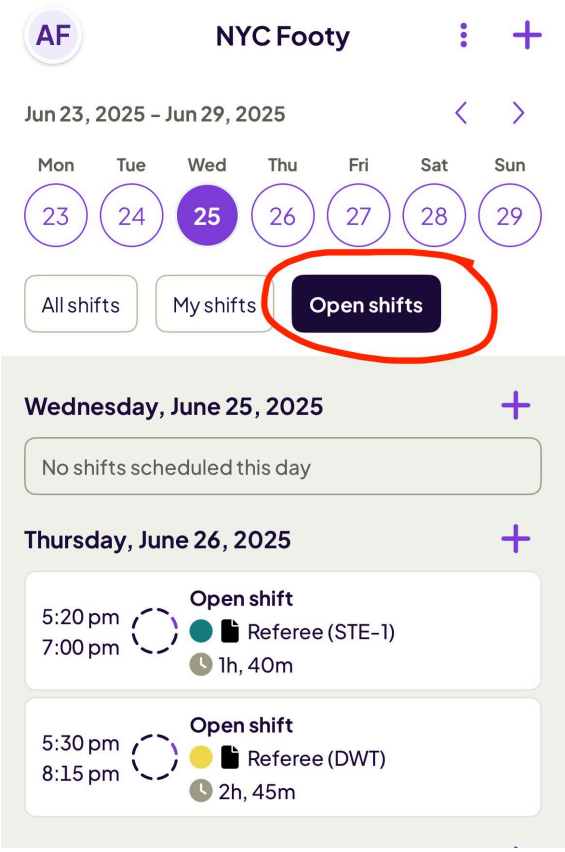
These are some simple steps to follow when requesting a cover:

- As soon as you realize the need for cover, ***the earlier the better***, log-in into **Homebase**, click on **My Shifts**, select **Find Cover,** then click on **Request Cover**. Now you'll have the choice to select referees to cover, select those who you think they'll be able to accept your request. Select All to send a notification to the whole roster.
- Once you select the referees, you'll be able to add a message to it before sending. Message should include Division (e.g. P4), number of games and brief instructions on Field (e.g. No Field Setup Required).
- Next Step is to send a message on the "**NYC FOOTY REFEREES**" Whatsapp group. Messages should be brief and include key information about the shift, for example: "Hey all, I'm in need of coverage for next Saturday November 14th, 8:30am-12:30pm P4 at Pier 40, 3 Games. I've put the request on Homebase, thank you".
- At this point, if someone accepts the coverage, one of the Footy Admins will need to approve the request. N.B. Make sure the shift gets approved in advance, if no one has approved the coverage and the shift is upcoming in the next couple of days, reach out to Andrew to follow-up and confirm. <u>If no one has approved it</u> <u>yet, the shift is still considered yours.</u>
- Final Step, once the shift gets approved, it is your responsibility to reach out to the covering referee and provide all needed information regarding the shift (e.g. Field Setup, Balls needs, Division, Key/Lock needs, Goal moving/building, specific rules for the field, etc. etc.). Make sure the covering referee acknowledges the shift requirements and you'll be set.

PICKING UP SHIFTS

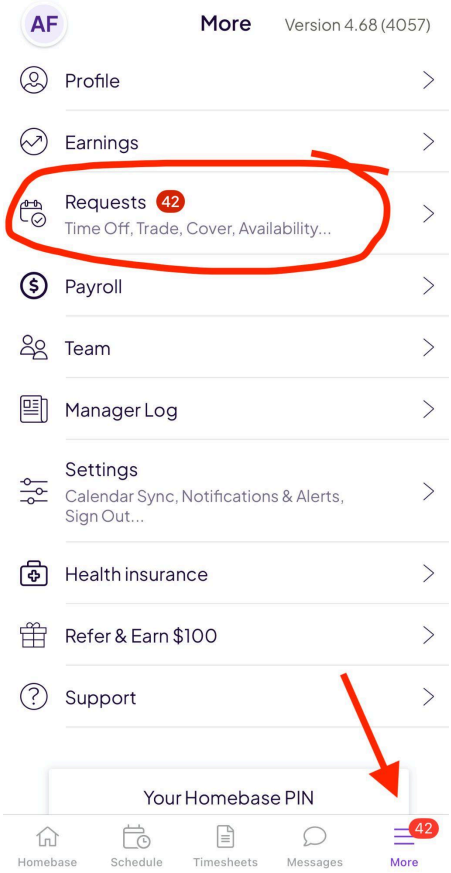
Our league schedule is constantly changing, as are the schedules of our referees. Picking up cover shifts and open shifts is an expectation of all referees on our roster; referees who do not regularly pick up shifts will be considered inactive and removed from the referee roster. Referees who pick up cover shifts and open shifts will also be contributing to their own eligibility for bonuses and supporting our collective efforts to provide our players with the best experience possible.

An **Open Shift** is one that has not been assigned to any referee, and can be claimed by any referee as soon as it appears on Homebase. Find Open Shifts here on the app:



Circles next to listed shifts indicate the skill level of the league:

A **Cover Request** comes from a referee who is assigned a shift but needs to be replaced on a one-time basis. You will receive notifications from Homebase when a cover is requested of you. You can then find those requests here for your response:



In all cases, it is not first-come, first-served - we need as many claims on all cover shifts as possible, in order to distribute referees effectively based on experience level, location, and other factors. A shift is not yours until it is approved by an admin, after which it will appear on your shift schedule.

On Field Issues Affecting Timesheets and Pay Rates

Forfeits

•If a team forfeits a game the *shift is still on as scheduled*. An opposing team or spare players from the forfeiting team still have the option of a refereed scrimmage on an NYC Footy field during their allotted time. Admins will confirm in the Captain's Chat whether the field will be in use. If players want to play, your shift goes on as scheduled, and you are responsible for refereeing, setting up and taking down the field as scheduled.

If there is a forfeit or both teams choose not to use their field time, remember you may have additional games on your schedule, and they will be played *as scheduled*. (We cannot necessarily bring teams early if the game before theirs is cancelled.) Your shift continues as scheduled.

If a game scheduled is forfeited in advance of a shift, your shift time *may* be reduced or altered to reflect the new schedule (provided it is greater than 1.5 hours).

Cancellations

In the event of a *league initiated* cancellation due to weather, facility disruptions, or teams forfeiting with advance notice:

-if the cancellation is announced 1 hour or more before the shift, the shift is cancelled and removed from the schedule. There is no compensation.

-if the cancellation is announced less than 1 hour before the scheduled shift, you will receive a 1.5 hours minimum shift pay

-if the cancellation occurs *during your shift* (i.e. the last game of your shift is cancelled, or weather conditions worsen), you will receive payment for the length of time you worked up until the cancellation OR 1.5 hours, whichever is greater.

SERIOUS INJURY PROTOCOL

Injuries are an inevitable part of the game - it is also the moment when players in a rec league may be most stressed out and emotional, so we want NYC Footy Refs to be prepared for this from both a professional and personal perspective.

We suggest you follow these points in the event of an injury that you deem serious. But first, please remember that ***checking on the player and showing concern goes a long way for players sense of security***

• Manage the game

- stop play **& prioritize the safety and security of the injured player**
- allow teammates or a captain to check in with the injured player
- if the injury was the result of a cautionable offense, hand out the caution and deal with the offending team
- make a note of the time stoppage

• Manage the players

- you are not required or expected to administer first aid. If first aid is required, you may offer the captain your first aid kit.
- once you've managed the game, check in with the injured player/ their captain to determine if they
    - can continue or need to come off
    - need additional medical care (ambulance/ ER) **Do not call an ambulance yourself** - only the captains/ players should do this, if it is called for. One exception: If an injured player is unresponsive, call 911.

It's important that we're attending to the players' experience here as well as the game. If the player can be moved, encourage them to leave the field (with teammates' support if needed) so that the game can continue for the remaining players. Let them take the time needed - you can borrow a few moments from halftime to make it up.

- inform the captain that the extent of medical intervention required is *up to them and the injured player*, it is not the referee's role.

• Manage the post-game

- File a **detailed** incident report in the Ref HQ app, including names of any players involved
- Drop a note in the Ref Ops chat that we should look out for this incident and a quick summary of what happened

INCLEMENT WEATHER PROTOCOL

GAMES ARE ALWAYS ON UNLESS YOU HEAR OTHERWISE DIRECTLY FROM NYC FOOTY ADMINS.

Weather decisions are made on a field-by-field basis, depending on actual conditions at the time.

When Do We Play?

- Mild conditions
- Rain or shine. Even heavy rain.*
- Snow and, often, on snow-covered fields. †
- When it's very cold (bundle up).
- When it's very hot (bring extra fluids).

In all conditions, referees must have their uniform visible as their top layer.

**Exceptions may be made for games scheduled to take place on natural turf (i.e. grass) fields.*

† Exceptions are made if the snow is deemed unsafe (e.g. significant ice coverage preventing "soccer movements").

Thunderstorm Policy

Before Kickoff:

If a neighborhood or field is not actively experiencing thunderstorms, games will proceed as scheduled.

If thunderstorms are present before kickoff, NYC Footy staff will cancel games only if storms are highly likely to continue during play.

During Gameplay:

If you see visible lightning during the game:

- Stop play and direct players (and yourself) to safe cover.
- Check your watch and begin a **10 minute count** - if no lightning strikes are visible in that time, you may resume play.
- Notify the Ref Ops chat of the lightning suspension
- If lightning recurs, restart your 10 minute count. Restart that count each time lightning is visible. After 30 total minutes of delay, the game will be cancelled.
- Ref Admins will instruct you whether to deduct the delay time from your game, or if subsequent games can be pushed later by the delay. (This will be dependent on many factors, including permit time and game schedules.)

If the game is cancelled, notify the Ref Ops chat and include at what point in gameplay it was suspended. Games ended in the first half *may* be rescheduled if permit time allows, but we cannot guarantee anything to the players. Games ended in the second half will be considered played in full.

Snow and Ice Policy

Pre-Kickoff Field Inspections:

Our Field Ops team will do their best to evaluate field conditions several hours before kickoff and provide a field condition report that assesses the playability of the field (e.g. allowing for soccer movements). Referees may be charged with field inspection closer to game time, which will be communicated via Ref Ops chats.

NYC Footy's 3 Decision-Making Scenarios:

1 - Safe to Play:

The field is deemed safe for gameplay, even if covered in snow or light ice.
Key Consideration: Ice that is loose, thin, or breaks easily under weight is acceptable. Dangerous ice that causes consistent slipping and falling will result in cancellation. Anything in-between typically calls for the "Polar Protocol".

2 - "Polar Protocol" – Player Preference:

When fields are significantly impacted by snow and/or ice but not deemed unplayable, **captains will be polled in advance in the Captains Chat** by NYC Footy staff on whether or not they'd like to play (players must wait for the staff poll to vote on playing or not).
Games will be played only if both teams opt in.
Referees will be kept informed of the outcome via the Ref Ops chats.

3 - Unplayable Conditions – Game Cancellations:

If the field is deemed unsafe and/or the facility/park is closed, games are canceled. <u>The final decision for this condition will fall to the referee at the time of kickoff</u> (as conditions may change from a prematch inspection). In this scenario the referee should refer player concerns regarding rescheduling to the league, via the Captain's Chat and/or info@nycfooty.com.

Air Quality Policy

Real-Time Monitoring:

We use apps like AirNow, IQAir, and Google to track air quality changes in real-time.

Decision Criteria:

Good, Moderate, or Unhealthy for Sensitive Groups: Games will proceed as scheduled.
Unhealthy or Worse: Games may be canceled.

Timing of Decisions:

Similar to our weather protocol, we wait as long as possible to make informed decisions. Game cancellations are typically announced about **2 hours before kickoff**.

Referees with specific health concerns should notify admins at the earliest possible opportunity in order to let us seek shift coverage as needed.

REFEREE EMPLOYMENT STRUCTURE

NYC Footy Referee Tiers and Pay Levels

- **Tiro** - A referee who is starting out with NYC Footy or gaining needed experience as a referee
    - Eligible for P5, P4, and occasional P3 divisions
    - $25-$29/hour
    - Could be eligible for emergency coverage of P2 with manager approval

- **Intermediate** - A referee with more experience and who meets NYC Footy Referee standards without additional guidance
    - Eligible for P5 - P2 and occasionally P1 divisions
    - $30-$34/hour

- **Senior** - An experienced referee able to take on additional 'lead ref' duties at multifield locations and who goes above and beyond to ensure the highest standard of conduct on the pitch.
    - Eligible for all divisions
    - $35/hour

- **Referee Mentor -** A Senior Referee that is also eligible for an additional support/training role for referees of all tiers. More on this role below.

Compensation Details for all Levels

- Each referee is assigned a fixed hourly pay rate calculated upon hire and based on several factors, including our training evaluation and tier level.

- The minimum length of a shift is 1.5 hours - if you are assigned a shift of only a single game and your working time is less than this, your timesheet will be edited to meet the minimum shift length. (See more about minimum shift lengths and game cancellations/ forfeits below)

- Pay rate increases will be available based on consecutive seasonal seniority, acquisition of additional professional development, and other factors - see more about this below.

Payroll Note

Payroll is performed through Homebase and is paid out biweekly. The payroll cycle is Monday through the following Sunday; wages earned during that cycle will be paid on the Friday following.

Seasonal Bonuses

Each referee is eligible for a seasonal performance and retention bonus after the end of every NYC Footy season (Winter/Spring/Summer/Fall) if they meet the following performance qualifications:

- Worked a minimum of **30 hours** across the season
- For those with a seasonal assignment, attended *at minimum* 85% of their assigned season's matches (did not request excessive covers)
- Consistently clocked in **on schedule and on location for 100% of their shifts** (and clocked out as well a **minimum** of 80% on schedule and on location)
- Entered their official scores in either Ref HQ or to the Ref Ops chat on Whatsapp within 12 hours of the final whistle in 100% of their shifts.
- Had no performance-based probations or suspensions in the qualifying season
- Successfully embodied NYC Footy values and conducted themselves professionally and effectively on the pitch

For bonus eligibility, referees must *also* achieve the following *retention* goals:

- Are actively refereeing at the time of bonus distributions (within 1 month following the end of the season)
- Make themselves available for a seasonal assignment in the *subsequent* season (as opposed to listing for covers only/ inactive status)

Retention exception:

- After **6 seasons** of refereeing with NYC Footy, a referee may become eligible for a retention exception *at the discretion of NYC Footy Referee Admins*. A retention exception would allow a qualified referee who achieved ALL of the performance incentives to receive a *partial* seasonal bonus if they do not meet the retention criteria with a demonstrable/ documented reason for being unable to remain active in the required window *but who intends to return to active status*.

Shortfalls in certain aspects of the performance bonus criteria can sometimes be offset by *picking up numerous cover shifts* or other indicators of efforts to support our referee community.

Additional bonus is available for *flying above and beyond* (FAB) - helping your fellow refs, players, and the league in big and small ways that go beyond the basics. Has a fellow ref done something extraordinary? Give them a shoutout on the NYC Footy Ref chat so we can hear about it! FAB ticks may be calculated in seasonal bonus calculations. Players will also be asked to provide feedback on referee performance on their player's app.

Tier Promotion and Pay Raises

Eligibility for tier or pay rate promotion are the same as those for seasonal bonuses (see above), and in addition requires **four consecutive seasons of activity/100 hours minimum (min. seven active months out of the year).** Promotion cycles occur quarterly (after each season). Pay raises requested

and given at the end of a season will be active for the following season. If a referee wishes to make a request, carefully review the eligibility criteria and send an email with your qualifications and the nature of your request to your referee admins.

Senior Referee Mentors - Senior referees are eligible to conduct training observations of fellow NYC Footy referees. As a Mentor, they can receive additional shifts in which they observe and support other referees and provide feedback on performance. These mentorship shifts will be paid as normal shifts at the referee's existing rate, and hours count toward seasonal bonuses. In order to become eligible for this upgrade, a mentor referee must: have 3-5 years of experience and USSF (or other recognized association) license; maintain a perfect record of the bonus metrics for 2 consecutive seasons; have upheld NYC Footy Referee values on a consistent basis, and/or equivalent accomplishment as evaluated by NYC Footy administrative team.

Senior Referee Mentor Guide

As a Senior Referee you may earn the opportunity for additional shifts as a Referee Mentor. This role is intended to help support referees as they improve their craft. It will be assigned as a regular referee shift, in parallel with a working referee's shift. (It may be possible to do two mentoring sessions for two different referees on a multi-field setup.)

The Referee Mentor will attend the mentee's game and observe pre-match, match, and post-match. They will provide constructive feedback during halftime, and evaluate how effectively the referee integrates the feedback in the 2nd half. Finally, the Referee Mentor will fill out and submit the NYC Footy Observation Form. A summary of this feedback form will be shared with the mentee ref.

Performance Evaluation and Improvement

We want to help NYC Footy Referees get the most out of their time with the league and to be able to improve, grow, earn, and work as much as possible. In order to help each other improve, we will also be developing some new structures that we hope will help you move through the tier structure and improve your refereeing skills.

Observations - To support ref development, Referee Managers and Senior Mentor Referees will provide occasional in-person observations of games, with feedback given on site and in writing.

Player Feedback - The NYC Footy Player app will provide players an opportunity to leave feedback on referee performance as well. While we understand the player-referee dynamic well and will evaluate comments on specific calls subjectively, we *will* weigh the tone of player feedback in evaluating a seasonal performance. Additionally, all confirmed player-reported instances of NYC Footy rules not being enforced (i.e. uniforms, shinpads, etc) will impact referee performance reviews.

Seasonal self-evaluation - Seasonally-assigned referees will also be asked to submit a self-evaluation at the end of the season, intended to help refs reflect on areas of strength or areas that need improvement. This will also be an opportunity for refs to give feedback to NYC Footy's Ref Operations Department, and offer suggestions, ask questions, or propose policies that could be streamlined or improved.

Seasonal Manager Evaluations - At the end of each season, we will combine a review of our season long performance metrics with a review of observations and other qualitative measures (shoutouts, above-and-beyond moments, community engagement, player feedback, incident reports) and offer selected seasonal referees written feedback intended to help strengthen their game for the upcoming season.

League trainings - Each year NYC Footy will offer periodic group training meetups to help refresh refs on NYC Footy specific rules or seasonal adjustments.

Incentives - NYC Footy Referees are eligible to receive

As an Individual:

25% off individual registration after 1 season (when active) (50% after 6 months of continuous refereeing), or a free season after one year (1 league per season)

And, as a Team Captain:

10% regular price off team captain registration (no limit to number of teams, must be listed as team captain)

Disciplinary Code

Generally, we want to encourage referee improvement and growth, and help NYC Footy Referees earn while being close to the game we all love. We also want NYC Footy to have the best, most professional referees of any adult recreational league in the country. In order to do this, we will also maintain high standards and act when a referee falls below those expectations. Discipline will be handled on a case by case basis, but will generally follow the structure below.

Warning - depending on the nature of the offense, a warning may be first issued (examples: referee out of uniform, lateness, persistent failure to enforce league rules)

First discipline - *minimum* 1 week shift suspension and 1 month probation

Second discipline - *minimum* 2 week shift suspension and season long probation

Third discipline - Season long suspension

(Probation = subsequent games will be observed and any discrepancies on timesheet, score delivery, field conduct, or player reports will trigger the next discipline)

DATED MARCH 2024
PREPARED BY GIANLUCA PALANCA AND ANDREW FREIBAND
FOR NYC FOOTY